

Sounds a bit Dickensian.

It was a fantastic learning experience, but I would have much preferred to read about it. Emotionally, the highs got lower, and the lows became incredibly low.

Specifically, what happened?

Let me give you the story of the first day.

You are really one for memorable first days.

On my first day, I did my first trade, and I made £37,000 or about \$60,000 on my \$300,000 cash. I walked out of the kitchen and said to my wife at the time, “I just made £37,000. It is going to be a success. I don’t have to worry about the seed capital. If I can keep compounding like this, we’ll be in great shape.”

She said, “That is really good, but garbage collection is happening in 10 minutes. If you don’t get the bins down to the bottom of the drive in time, we’re going to miss it, and we’ll have all the garbage in the garden for the next week.”

I remember literally answering, “But I am a master of the universe.”

She said, “Yes and you now have eight minutes to get the rubbish down to the bottom of the driveway.”

I remember walking down the garden, carrying the garbage bags, and muttering to myself, “I am a fucking master of the fucking universe. I just made fucking £37,000, and I am carrying the fucking rubbish out.” That was the high point of my experience the first time I ran a hedge fund. That was as good as it ever got.

What went wrong?

After that, I made some money and lost some money, and then—I don’t know if I should go into this . . .

Don’t worry, we can always take it out if it’s a problem.

I worked very closely with a guy when I was at NatWest, and he really stitched me. He strongly recommended that I buy a stock, which I did buy. The next day, the stock had a big loss. I waited for a phone call from him, but it never came. Eventually, I called him and asked him what was